

AG2120 International Administration and Policy

Course report, Fall 2023

The course was in many respects similar to the 2022 version. Like last year, the first part of the course focused on questions of international administration and policy relating to armed conflict and post-conflict societies, reintroducing Kristen Kao's lecture and seminar on transitional justice next to Magnus Lundgren's series on armed conflict and conflict resolution. The second part of the course was structured like in the previous year, addressing topics relating to aid, development, corruption, and democratization, with a focus on how international actors and interventions could promote desirable outcomes. The teachers were Agnes Cornell, Marcia Grimes, and Adea Gafuri,

The course offered students a choice of six different seminars, three in the first half and three in the second half. Like before, students were required to write two shorter seminar papers, make one oral presentation, and write one longer research paper. Also like before, there was also a final "student conference," during which students presented their research papers in a group format. In response to feedback from last year, the supervision sessions for the research paper were scheduled before Christmas, intended to allow the students more time to work on their papers.

Overall, the course evaluations suggest that the course has worked relatively well. Of the students who responded to the evaluation survey, 73 percent rate the course as either "very good" or "rather good". 87 percent of respondents also rate the lecturers and the teachers in these two categories. 47 percent rate the course as "very good" Also, 93% of respondents rate the course organization and information as "very good" or "rather good". 93% rate the policy brief seminar assignments as "very good" or "good". The final research paper assignment is somewhat less favorably rated, but 53% still rate it as "very good" or "rather good".

These evaluations are somewhat worse than the two preceding years but it is not obvious why. The provided comments suggest few systematic patterns. A few things stand out as areas where the course could improve. First, the connection between different parts of the course could be enhanced further. It is clear that students are more satisfied with the parts of the course that offer an integrated "narrative" and less happy with those parts that have less chances of offering such a narrative. Second, some students appear dissatisfied with the nature of the literature review assignments, saying it was unclear or too demanding, or both. This is something that the course team can work on improving for future years.

A problem that is not apparent from the course evaluations is plagiarism. During the course, one student investigated for possible plagiarism and several students were warned. Since similar problems have appeared in previous versions, the course already discusses this topic and clearly warns the students of the implications of plagiarism but further efforts will be taken, especially relating to clarifying rules for the use of AI. It is also recommended that the Department considers other options for addressing the problem of plagiarism and especially in courses with a high proportion of visiting or foreign students.

Below is a summary of how the course was rated based on responses to each of the questions in the course evaluation by the 15 students that completed the evaluation.

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Respondents: 40
Answer Count: 15
Answer Frequency: 37,50 %

Overall, how would you assess the course?

Overall, how would you assess the course?	Number of responses
Very good	7 (46,7%)
Rather good	4 (26,7%)
Neither good nor bad	4 (26,7%)
Rather bad	0 (0,0%)
Very bad	0 (0,0%)
Total	15 (100,0%)



	Mean	Standard Deviation	Coefficient of Variation	Min	Lower Quartile	Median	Upper Quartile	Max
Overall, how would you assess the course?	1,8	0,9	47,9 %	1,0	1,0	2,0	2,5	3,0

Overall, how would you assess the lectures?

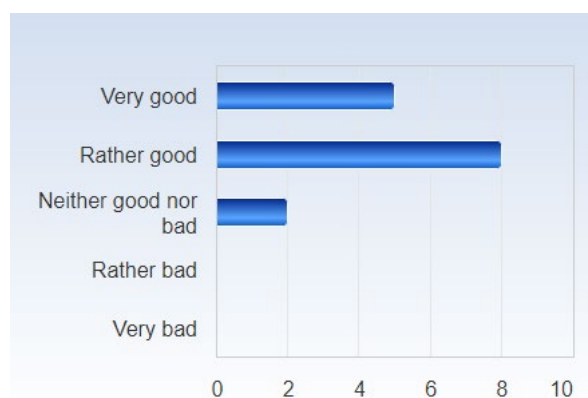
Overall, how would you assess the lectures?	Number of responses
Very good	4 (26,7%)
Rather good	6 (40,0%)
Neither good nor bad	4 (26,7%)
Rather bad	1 (6,7%)
Very bad	0 (0,0%)
Total	15 (100,0%)



	Mean	Standard Deviation	Coefficient of Variation	Min	Lower Quartile	Median	Upper Quartile	Max
Overall, how would you assess the lectures?	2,1	0,9	42,9 %	1,0	1,5	2,0	3,0	4,0

Overall, how would you assess the teachers?

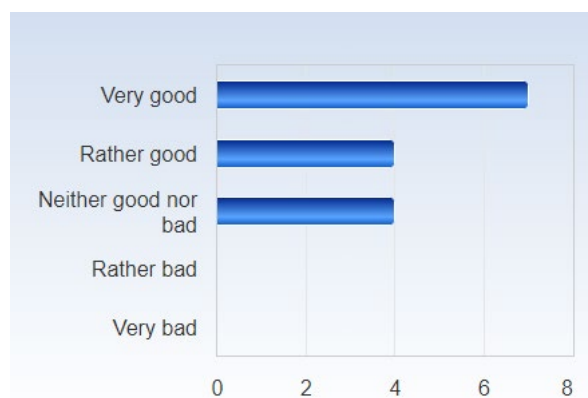
Overall, how would you assess the teachers?	Number of responses
Very good	5 (33,3%)
Rather good	8 (53,3%)
Neither good nor bad	2 (13,3%)
Rather bad	0 (0,0%)
Very bad	0 (0,0%)
Total	15 (100,0%)



	Mean	Standard Deviation	Coefficient of Variation	Min	Lower Quartile	Median	Upper Quartile	Max
Overall, how would you assess the teachers?	1,8	0,7	37,6 %	1,0	1,0	2,0	2,0	3,0

Overall, how would you assess the literature?

Overall, how would you assess the literature?	Number of responses
Very good	7 (46,7%)
Rather good	4 (26,7%)
Neither good nor bad	4 (26,7%)
Rather bad	0 (0,0%)
Very bad	0 (0,0%)
Total	15 (100,0%)



	Mean	Standard Deviation	Coefficient of Variation	Min	Lower Quartile	Median	Upper Quartile	Max
Overall, how would you assess the literature?	1,8	0,9	47,9 %	1,0	1,0	2,0	2,5	3,0

Overall, how would you assess the seminars?

Overall, how would you assess the seminars?	Number of responses
Very good	6 (40,0%)
Rather good	7 (46,7%)
Neither good nor bad	1 (6,7%)
Rather bad	1 (6,7%)
Very bad	0 (0,0%)
Total	15 (100,0%)



	Mean	Standard Deviation	Coefficient of Variation	Min	Lower Quartile	Median	Upper Quartile	Max
Overall, how would you assess the seminars?	1,8	0,9	47,9 %	1,0	1,0	2,0	2,0	4,0

Overall, how would you assess the usefulness of the policy brief assignments?

Overall, how would you assess the usefulness of the policy brief assignments?	Number of responses
Very good	9 (60,0%)
Rather good	5 (33,3%)
Neither good nor bad	0 (0,0%)
Rather bad	1 (6,7%)
Very bad	0 (0,0%)
Total	15 (100,0%)



	Mean	Standard Deviation	Coefficient of Variation	Min	Lower Quartile	Median	Upper Quartile	Max
Overall, how would you assess the usefulness of the policy brief assignments?	1,5	0,8	54,4 %	1,0	1,0	1,0	2,0	4,0

Overall, how would you assess the usefulness of the literature assignments?

Overall, how would you assess the usefulness of the literature assignments?	Number of responses
Very good	4 (26,7%)
Rather good	5 (33,3%)
Neither good nor bad	3 (20,0%)
Rather bad	3 (20,0%)
Very bad	0 (0,0%)
Total	15 (100,0%)



	Mean	Standard Deviation	Coefficient of Variation	Min	Lower Quartile	Median	Upper Quartile	Max
Overall, how would you assess the usefulness of the literature assignments?	2,3	1,1	47,7 %	1,0	1,5	2,0	3,0	4,0

Overall, how would you assess the usefulness of the final paper assignment?

Overall, how would you assess the usefulness of the final paper assignment?	Number of responses
Very good	5 (33,3%)
Rather good	3 (20,0%)
Neither good nor bad	5 (33,3%)
Rather bad	2 (13,3%)
Very bad	0 (0,0%)
Total	15 (100,0%)



	Mean	Standard Deviation	Coefficient of Variation	Min	Lower Quartile	Median	Upper Quartile	Max
Overall, how would you assess the usefulness of the final paper assignment?	2,3	1,1	48,5 %	1,0	1,0	2,0	3,0	4,0

How would you assess the organization of the course, including the information on Canvas (information, schedule, administration)?

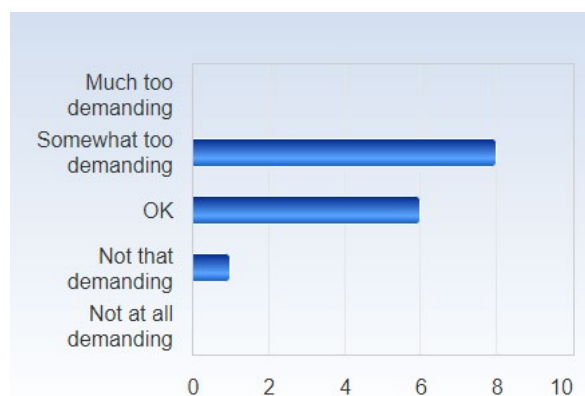
How would you assess the organization of the course, including the information on Canvas (information, schedule, administration)?	Number of responses
Very good	9 (60,0%)
Rather good	5 (33,3%)
Neither good nor bad	0 (0,0%)
Rather bad	0 (0,0%)
Very bad	1 (6,7%)
Total	15 (100,0%)



	Mean	Standard Deviation	Coefficient of Variation	Min	Lower Quartile	Median	Upper Quartile	Max
How would you assess the organization of the course, including the information on Canvas (information, schedule, administration)?	1,7	1,3	77,5 %	1,0	1,0	1,0	2,0	6,0

What is your assessment of the amount of work you have been requested to carry out during the course? Do you consider the course:

What is your assessment of the amount of work you have been requested to carry out during the course? Do you consider the course:	Number of responses
Much too demanding	0 (0,0%)
Somewhat too demanding	8 (53,3%)
OK	6 (40,0%)
Not that demanding	1 (6,7%)
Not at all demanding	0 (0,0%)
Total	15 (100,0%)



	Mean	Standard Deviation	Coefficient of Variation	Min	Lower Quartile	Median	Upper Quartile	Max
What is your assessment of the amount of work you have been requested to carry out during the course? Do you consider the course:	2,5	0,6	25,3 %	2,0	2,0	2,0	3,0	4,0

On average, approximately how much time do you spend on coursework, both in and outside of the classroom, per week?

On average, approximately how much time do you spend on coursework, both in and outside of the classroom, per week?	Number of responses
Less then 10 hours	1 (7,1%)
11-20 hours	4 (28,6%)
21-30 hours	6 (42,9%)
31-40 hours	3 (21,4%)
More than 40 hours	0 (0,0%)
Total	14 (100,0%)



	Mean	Standard Deviation	Coefficient of Variation	Min	Lower Quartile	Median	Upper Quartile	Max
On average, approximately how much time do you spend on coursework, both in and outside of the classroom, per week?	2,8	0,9	32,0 %	1,0	2,0	3,0	3,0	4,0